



**NATION
BUILDERS**

SPIRIT OF INDIA SPECIAL

SAIL Established 1954

One of the top five highest profit earning corporates in the country, the fully integrated iron and steel maker has a turnover of Rs 49,000 crore. SAIL is India's second largest producer of iron ore and has the second largest mines network.

HARD CORE

As far as slogans go, the Steel Authority of India has hit the nail on its head with "there is a little bit of SAIL in everybody's life". What makes this slogan so appropriate is that SAIL has been a vital part of the nation-building process for the last 50 years, supplying steel to projects of national importance. It has also developed several new products for sectors like defence, atomic energy, power, infrastructure, heavy machinery, oil and gas, telecom and railways. Some key projects where SAIL steel has been used are Chandrayaan, naval warships, the Bandra-Worli Sea Link, the Delhi Metro and the Commonwealth Games buildup. So much so, the rails made by SAIL for the Indian Railways, joined end-to-end, would circumnavigate the earth eight times.

With a turnover of Rs 49,000 crore, the fully integrated iron and steel maker is among the top five highest profit earning corporates in the country. SAIL manufactures and sells a broad range of steel products, including hot and cold rolled sheets and coils, galvanised and electrical sheets, structurals, railway products, plates, bars and rods, stainless steel and other alloy steels. SAIL produces iron and steel at five integrated plants and three special steel plants in the

60,000 tonnes
of steel has
been supplied
by SAIL for
three stadiums
in Delhi where
the Commonwealth
Games
will be held.



S.K. Roongta 58, Chairman

"SAIL has laid sound infrastructure in and around its townships that has turned obscure villages into large industrial centres."

eastern and central regions of India close to domestic sources of raw material. SAIL is India's second largest producer of iron ore and has the country's second largest mines network. This gives it a competitive edge in terms of captive availability of iron ore, limestone and dolomite, which are used to make steel.

The state-owned steel maker has been recession-proof. Despite the global economic slowdown, SAIL has clocked a net profit of \$570 million during the first half of the current financial year, the highest among all steel producers in the world. SAIL's

spirit of entrepreneurship is testified to by the fact that the largest number of Shram and Vishwakarma Awards are won by SAIL employees from among both private and public sector organisations. "Consolidating a road map for future, a massive modernisation and expansion plan for SAIL has been un-

dertaken to almost double its capacity of hot metal to 26 million tonnes in the next four or five years," says S.K. Roongta, chairman, SAIL.

SAIL's wide range of long and flat steel products are much in demand in the domestic as well as the international market. This vital responsibility is carried out by SAIL's own central marketing organisation (CMO) that transacts business through its network of 37 branch sales offices across the four regions, 65 warehouses and 26 customer contact offices. The CMO's domestic marketing effort is supplemented by its ever-widening network of rural dealers who meet the demands of the smallest customers in the remotest corners of the country. With the total number of dealers crossing 2,500, SAIL's wide marketing spread ensures availability of quality steel in virtually all the districts of the country. "We are building a strong and resilient SAIL to create a strong and resilient India," says Roongta. Only such resolve can explain this success.

by Abhijit Dasgupta